– if, as we said, your office environment demands only basic printing options. Nothing fancy. Also, laser and LED printers are faster than inkjet printers.

The decision to buy an inkjet printer for your office must be taken after extensive research about the printer's cartridge cost, yield, etc. Generally, as a thumb rule, inkjet printers are better at printing on various types of surfaces than laser or LED printers. But inkjets are slower in comparison. Also, if you buy a fast inkjet printer, its print quality won't be as great as a slow or average inkjet printer.

Network-ready printer?

This depends purely on whether you work alone or have a team of 2-3 mates whose work terminals aren't connected by a network. Basically, if you're fine with the idea of your work printer not being connected to someone else's PC (whoever sends the most print commands!), you should be fine with a printer without network printing options. However, if you have a network with more than a few terminals, then it's wise to have a network-enabled printer which comes with an ethernet port. Wireless printers are also a growing trend these days, when workplaces are going cableless.

The humble MFP – the all-rounder among printers

Duplex

This is probably the most under-rated feature in any printer, and it takes greater significance in an office environment. Duplexing simply means printing on both sides of a paper. Hence, printers with the duplex printing feature can print on both sides of papers fed through the tray. This feature goes a long way in deciding how much cost you incur on your office's paper expenditure.

Monochrome printer in all its glory

This is all about single-function printers which can only print files from a command given by a computer. Let's consider another option should you contemplate buying an all-in-one device.

Should you buy an MFP?

MFP or multi-function printers are a breed of printers that don't just output printed files on paper, but also allow you to scan images of paper and quickly photocopy them. Some of these MFPs also come equipped with a fax modem to send and receive fax.

A couple of things to remember before quickly making up your mind in favour of an MFP of your favourite printer brand. If you scan a lot of copies (over 100 in a day), you're better off having a dedicated scanner for that job which will have a better ADF (automatic document feeder) for scanning multipage documents. Also a dedicated scanner will work much faster than an average MFP. Do people even use fax these days?

Hope these lesser known facts help you buy the right printer for your home office.